REGULATORY STATE AND QUASI JUDICIAL INSTITUTIONS

WHY REGULATION -> THREE AXES -> FAIR DECISION -> SECTOR LAW/APPEAL -> INDEPENDENCE/CAPTURE -> PYQ EXECUTION -> SYNTHESIS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g3 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 WHY THE REGULATORY STATE EMERGED

WHY THE REGULATORY STATE EMERGED | ROOT QUESTION | HOW CAN THE STATE GOVERN COMPLEX MARKETS AND RIGHTS | LIBERALISATION/SPECIALISATION LESS DIRECT PRODUCTION | MORE RULE-SETTING, NETWORK ACCESS, PRUDENTIAL OVERSIGHT | CONSUMER/COMPETITION PROTECTION | SPECIALISED ENFORCEMENT AND ADJUDICATION. | MARKET FAILURES ------ MONOPOLY

ROOT QUESTION

How can the State govern complex markets and rights without daily ministerial case control? → LIBERALISATION/SPECIALISATION less direct production → more rule-setting, network access, prudential oversight → consumer/competition protection → specialised enforcement and adjudication.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ROOT QUESTION
- How can the State govern complex markets and rights without daily ministerial case control?
- LIBERALISATION/SPECIALISATION less direct production → more rule-setting, network access, prudential oversight

POWER / PROCEDURE

- consumer/competition protection → specialised enforcement and adjudication.
- MARKET FAILURES ------ monopoly
- information asymmetry

CHECK / LIMIT

- systemic risk
- GOVERNANCE NEEDS ------ expertise
- credible commitment

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- rapid updating
- CONSTITUTIONAL NEED - mandate
- Regulation is a change in State technique, not disappearance of the State.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The regulatory state expanded to manage technical and rapidly changing sectors, but expertise and continuity can create insulation, capture and democratic deficit.

01

STAGE 01 SOURCE, FUNCTION AND DECISIONAL CHARACTER

SOURCE, FUNCTION AND DECISIONAL CHARACTER | LEGAL SOURCE PRIMARY FUNCTION CHARACTER OF ACT CONSTITUTIONAL REGULATORY | STATUTORY REGULATORS WITH DIFFERENT MANDATES. | MASTER TRAP ONE BODY MAY OCCUPY SEVERAL BOXES. IT

BODY / AUTHORITY

LEGAL SOURCE PRIMARY FUNCTION CHARACTER OF ACT constitutional regulatory quasi-legislative rule statutory advisory administrative inquiry → RBI/SEBI/TRAI/CERC/IRDAI/CCI -- statutory regulators with different mandates. → MASTER TRAP one body may occupy several boxes; it is not quasi-judicial in every function.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- BODY / AUTHORITY
- LEGAL SOURCE PRIMARY FUNCTION CHARACTER OF ACT constitutional regulatory quasi-legislative rule statutory advisory administrative inquiry executive investigative quasi-judicial

POWER / PROCEDURE

- RBI/SEBI/TRAI/CERC/IRDAI/CCI -- statutory regulators with different mandates.
- MASTER TRAP one body may occupy several boxes; it is not quasi-judicial in every function.

CHECK / LIMIT

- BODY / AUTHORITY
- LEGAL SOURCE PRIMARY FUNCTION CHARACTER OF ACT constitutional regulatory quasi-legislative rule statutory advisory administrative inquiry executive investigative quasi-judicial

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- RBI/SEBI/TRAI/CERC/IRDAI/CCI -- statutory regulators with different mandates.
- MASTER TRAP one body may occupy several boxes; it is not quasi-judicial in every function.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Bar Council regulates a profession under statute, whereas the Law Commission recommends reform without itself changing law.

02

STAGE 02 REGULATORY CYCLE AND SEPARATION PROBLEM

REGULATORY CYCLE AND SEPARATION PROBLEM | PARENT ACT REGULATION/STANDARD | INVESTIGATION SHOW-CAUSE NOTICE | REASONED ORDER/PENALTY | STATUTORY APPEAL | HIGH COURT/SUPREME COURT CONSTITUTIONAL REVIEW. | CONCENTRATION RISK MAKE RULE + INVESTIGATE + PROSECUTE + CONFIRMATION BIAS/SELF-VINDICATION.

PARENT ACT -regulation/standard -- licence/tariff -- data/monitoring -- investigation show-cause notice -- hearing -- → High Court/Supreme Court constitutional review. → CONCENTRATION RISK make rule + investigate + prosecute + decide -- confirmation bias/self-vindication. → SAFEGUARDS separate wings → unbiased member

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PARENT ACT regulation/standard -- licence/tariff -- data/monitoring -- investigation show-cause notice -- hearing -- reasoned order/penalty -- statutory
- High Court/Supreme Court constitutional review.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- CONCENTRATION RISK make rule + investigate + prosecute + decide -- confirmation bias/self-vindication.
- SAFEGUARDS separate wings

CHECK / LIMIT

- unbiased member
- external appeal.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ANSWER STRIP
- Efficiency can justify combined functions; fairness requires functional separation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The regulatory cycle moves from standards and licences through monitoring, hearing and reasoned orders to appeal, making procedural fairness integral to enforcement.

03

STAGE 03 NATURAL JUSTICE AND DELEGATED-POWER CASES

NATURAL JUSTICE AND DELEGATED-POWER CASES | IN RE DELHI LAWS ACT (1951) | ESSENTIAL LEGISLATIVE FUNCTION CANNOT BE ABDICATED. | A.K. KRAIPAK V. UNION OF INDIA (1969) | BIAS RULE: ADMINISTRATIVE/QUASI-JUDICIAL LINE IS THIN. | MANEKA GANDHI (1978) | FAIR, JUST AND REASONABLE PROCEDURE. | S.N. MUKHERJEE V. UNION OF INDIA (1990)

In re Delhi Laws Act (1951) → essential legislative function cannot be abdicated. → A.K. Kraipak v. Union of India (1969) → Bias rule: administrative/quasi-judicial line is thin. → Maneka Gandhi (1978) -- fair, just and reasonable procedure.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- In re Delhi Laws Act (1951)
- essential legislative function cannot be abdicated.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- A.K. Kraipak v. Union of India (1969)
- bias rule: administrative/quasi-judicial line is thin.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Maneka Gandhi (1978) -- fair, just and reasonable procedure.
- S.N. Mukherjee v. Union of India (1990) -- reasoned decision supports review.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- NATURAL JUSTICE CORE notice + hearing + no bias + relevant evidence + speaking order.
- LIMIT procedure is context-sensitive; statutory silence is not permission for arbitrariness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Natural justice restrains bias and unheard adverse decisions, but its flexible content varies with context rather than reproducing full court procedure everywhere.

04

STAGE 04 REGULATOR, TRIBUNAL, COMMISSION AND COURT

REGULATOR, TRIBUNAL, COMMISSION AND COURT | COURT GENERAL CONSTITUTIONAL/STATUTORY ADJUDICATION + FORMAL JUDICIAL AUTHORITY | TRIBUNAL SPECIALISED STATUTORY ADJUDICATION | MERITS APPEAL/REVIEW CHAIN. | REGULATOR SECTOR RULE/LICENCE/SUPERVISION/ENFORCEMENT + CASE-SPECIFIC ADJUDICATION WHEN EMPOWERED. | COMMISSION NAME ALONE PROVES NOTHING | MAY ADVISE, INVESTIGATE, REGULATE OR ADJUDICATE. | L. CHANDRA KUMAR (1997) TRIBUNALISATION CANNOT REMOVE HIGH COURT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
COURT general constitutional/statutory adjudication + formal judicial authority.	REGULATOR sector rule/licence/supervision/enforcement + case-specific adjudication when empowered.	L. Chandra Kumar (1997) tribunalisation cannot remove High Court judicial review.	civil-court powers != court
TRIBUNAL specialised statutory adjudication → merits appeal/review chain.	COMMISSION name alone proves nothing: may advise, investigate, regulate or adjudicate.	TRAP specialised != tribunal	recommendation != binding order.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- COURT general constitutional/statutory adjudication + formal judicial authority.
- TRIBUNAL specialised statutory adjudication → merits appeal/review chain.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- REGULATOR sector rule/licence/supervision/enforcement + case-specific adjudication when empowered.
- COMMISSION name alone proves nothing: may advise, investigate, regulate or adjudicate.

CHECK / LIMIT

- L. Chandra Kumar (1997) tribunalisation cannot remove High Court judicial review.
- TRAP specialised != tribunal

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- civil-court powers != court
- recommendation != binding order.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — REGULATOR sector rule/licence/supervision/enforcement + case-specific adjudication when empowered.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Courts exercise general judicial power, tribunals specialise in adjudication, and regulators combine policy with enforcement, while each remains subject to constitutional review.

05

STAGE 05 REGULATOR POWER, APPEALABILITY AND JUDICIAL CONTROL

REGULATOR POWER, APPEALABILITY AND JUDICIAL CONTROL | COMPETITION COMMISSION OF INDIA V. SAIL (2010) | STATUTORY STAGE AND CHARACTER DETERMINE HEARING/APPEALABILITY | NOT EVERY CCI STEP IS A FINAL QUASI-JUDICIAL ORDER. | CELLULAR OPERATORS ASSOCIATION OF INDIA V. TRAI (2016) | REGULATION MUST REMAIN WITHIN STATUTE AND SATISFY NON-ARBITRARINESS. | APPEAL CHAIN EXAMPLES | SUPREME COURT QUESTION OF LAW.

Competition Commission of India v. SAIL (2010) → statutory stage and character determine hearing/appealability → not every CCI step is a final quasi-judicial order. → Cellular Operators Association of India v. TRAI (2016) → regulation must remain within statute and satisfy non-arbitrariness

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Competition Commission of India v. SAIL (2010)
- statutory stage and character determine hearing/appealability
- not every CCI step is a final quasi-judicial order.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Cellular Operators Association of India v. TRAI (2016)
- regulation must remain within statute and satisfy non-arbitrariness.
- APPEAL CHAIN EXAMPLES

CHECK / LIMIT

- SEBI -> SAT -- Supreme Court question of law.
- CCI -> NCLAT -- Supreme Court.
- TRAI dispute/appeal field -- TDSAT -- Supreme Court.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CERC/SERC -- APTEL -- Supreme Court.
- LIMIT statutory merits appeal differs from Article 226/227 legality review.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAT exercises adjudicatory authority but does not become a constitutional court equal to a High Court.

06

STAGE 06 INDEPENDENCE, ACCOUNTABILITY AND CAPTURE

INDEPENDENCE, ACCOUNTABILITY AND CAPTURE | INDEPENDENCE AXES APPOINTMENT | DECISIONAL NON-INTERFERENCE. | CAPTURE BRANCHES INDUSTRY | INFORMATION/REVOLVING DOOR/COGNITIVE DEPENDENCE. | SHORT-TERM DIRECTION OR INSECURE TENURE. | PARENT MINISTRY TREATS REGULATOR AS SUBORDINATE OFFICE. | ACCOUNTABILITY PARENT ACT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
INDEPENDENCE AXES appointment	political -> short-term direction or insecure tenure.	CAG where applicable	judicial review.
decisional non-interference.	bureaucratic -> parent ministry treats regulator as subordinate office.	RTI consultation	ANSWER STRIP
CAPTURE BRANCHES industry -> information/revolving door/cognitive dependence.	ACCOUNTABILITY parent Act	published reasons	Independence means insulation from case-specific control, not freedom from public reasons.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- INDEPENDENCE AXES appointment
- decisional non-interference.
- CAPTURE BRANCHES industry -> information/revolving door/cognitive dependence.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- political -> short-term direction or insecure tenure.
- bureaucratic -> parent ministry treats regulator as subordinate office.
- ACCOUNTABILITY parent Act

CHECK / LIMIT

- CAG where applicable
- RTI consultation
- published reasons

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- judicial review.
- ANSWER STRIP
- Independence means insulation from case-specific control, not freedom from public reasons.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Civil-court powers during inquiry do not convert a commission into a civil court or make every recommendation binding.

07

STAGE 07 ENABLING LAWS AND APPELLATE ROUTES

SOURCE -> REGULATOR -> APPEAL | RBI ACT 1934 / BANKING REGULATION ACT 1949 -- RBI -> REMEDY DEPENDS ON POWER | SEBI ACT 1992 -> SEBI -> SAT -> SUPREME COURT | TRAI ACT 1997 -> TRAI -> TDSAT -> SUPREME COURT | COMPETITION ACT 2002 -> CCI -> NCLAT -> SUPREME COURT | ELECTRICITY ACT 2003 -> CERC/SERC -> APTEL -> SUPREME COURT | PNGRB ACT 2006 -> DOWNSTREAM/MIDSTREAM FIELD; CRUDE OIL/GAS PRODUCTION EXCLUDE | ANSWER STRIP | NEVER INFER POWER OR APPEAL FROM AN INSTITUTIONAL LABEL; TRACE THE PARENT ACT.

SOURCE -> REGULATOR -> APPEAL

RBI Act 1934 / Banking Regulation Act 1949 -> RBI -> remedy depends on power → SEBI Act 1992 -> SEBI -> SAT -> Supreme Court → TRAI Act 1997 -> TRAI -> TDSAT -> Supreme Court

LEGAL SOURCE / FIELD

- SOURCE -> REGULATOR -> APPEAL
- RBI Act 1934 / Banking Regulation Act 1949 -> RBI -> remedy depends on power
- SEBI Act 1992 -> SEBI -> SAT -> Supreme Court

PROCEDURE / CONTROL

- TRAI Act 1997 -> TRAI -> TDSAT -> Supreme Court
- Competition Act 2002 -> CCI -> NCLAT -> Supreme Court
- Electricity Act 2003 -> CERC/SERC -> APTEL -> Supreme Court

EXAM LIMIT / USE

- PNGRB Act 2006 -> downstream/midstream field; crude oil/gas production excluded
- ANSWER STRIP
- Never infer power or appeal from an institutional label; trace the parent Act.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Read source, power, procedure and remedy as one bounded chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Never infer power or appeal from an institutional label; trace the parent Act.

08

STAGE 08 QUASI-JUDICIAL DECISION PROTOCOL

STATUTORY POWER -> COMPETENT STAGE -> NOTICE + DISCLOSURE | -> OPPORTUNITY TO ANSWER -> NO BIAS / RECUSAL -> RELEVANT EVIDENCE | -> REASONED PROPORTIONATE ORDER -> STATUTORY APPEAL | -> CONSTITUTIONAL REVIEW ON ITS PROPER FIELD | DOCTRINE | A.K. KRAIPAK V. UNION OF INDIA (1969): THIN ADMINISTRATIVE/QUASI-JUDICIAL LINE | S.N. MUKHERJEE V. UNION OF INDIA (1990): REASONS SUPPORT REVIEW | L. CHANDRA KUMAR (1997): CONSTITUTIONAL REVIEW FLOOR | COMPETITION COMMISSION OF INDIA V. SAIL (2010): STATUTORY STAGE CONTROLS APPEA

STATUTORY POWER -> COMPETENT STAGE -> NOTICE + DISCLOSURE

-> OPPORTUNITY TO ANSWER -> NO BIAS / RECUSAL -> RELEVANT EVIDENCE → -> REASONED PROPORTIONATE ORDER -> STATUTORY APPEAL → -> CONSTITUTIONAL REVIEW ON ITS PROPER FIELD

LEGAL SOURCE / FIELD

- STATUTORY POWER -> COMPETENT STAGE -> NOTICE + DISCLOSURE
- -> OPPORTUNITY TO ANSWER -> NO BIAS / RECUSAL -> RELEVANT EVIDENCE
- -> REASONED PROPORTIONATE ORDER -> STATUTORY APPEAL

PROCEDURE / CONTROL

- -> CONSTITUTIONAL REVIEW ON ITS PROPER FIELD
- DOCTRINE
- A.K. Kraipak v. Union of India (1969): thin administrative/quasi-judicial line

EXAM LIMIT / USE

- S.N. Mukherjee v. Union of India (1990): reasons support review
- L. Chandra Kumar (1997): constitutional review floor
- Competition Commission of India v. SAIL (2010): statutory stage controls appealability

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Read source, power, procedure and remedy as one bounded chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Natural justice is context-sensitive, but expertise is not a licence for arbitrariness.

09

STAGE 09 PYQ EXECUTION AND REFORM DIAGNOSIS

PRELIMS | SOURCE -> FUNCTION -> JURISDICTION EXCLUSION -> APPELLATE ROUTE -> CURRENT-STA | MAINS | IDENTIFY DEMAND -> QUALIFIED THESIS -> STATUTE/CASE -> MECHANISM | -> LIMITATION/CAPTURE -> ANSWER-SPECIFIC REFORM -> BALANCED VERDICT | REFORM MATCH | MANDATE GAP -> CLARIFY LAW | CAPACITY GAP -> STAFF/DATA | BIAS RISK -> FUNCTIONAL SEPARATION | CAPTURE -> CONFLICTS/CONSULTATION | FRAGMENTATION -> REFERRAL PROTOCOL | WEAK REMEDY -> COHERENT APPEAL

PRELIMS

source -> function -> jurisdiction exclusion -> appellate route -> current-status firewall → MAINS → identify demand -> qualified thesis -> statute/case -> mechanism

LEGAL SOURCE / FIELD

- PRELIMS
- source -> function -> jurisdiction exclusion -> appellate route -> current-status firewall
- MAINS

PROCEDURE / CONTROL

- identify demand -> qualified thesis -> statute/case -> mechanism
- -> limitation/capture -> answer-specific reform -> balanced verdict
- REFORM MATCH

EXAM LIMIT / USE

- mandate gap -> clarify law | capacity gap -> staff/data
- bias risk -> functional separation | capture -> conflicts/consultation
- fragmentation -> referral protocol | weak remedy -> coherent appeal

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Read source, power, procedure and remedy as one bounded chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A reform earns marks when it repairs the diagnosed institutional failure.

10

STAGE 10 DIGITAL AND PLATFORM REGULATION WITH LEGAL-STATUS FIREWALL

DIGITAL AND PLATFORM REGULATION WITH LEGAL-STATUS FIREWALL | DIGITAL HARMS NETWORK EFFECTS | DATA CONCENTRATION | DARK PATTERNS ALGORITHMIC OPACITY | CONSUMER/CHILD/CYBER RISK. | TOOL CHOICE COMPETITION LAW ---+-- DATA-PROTECTION DUTY CONSUMER LAW | REFORM TEST CLEAR HARM | STATUTORY POWER

DIGITAL HARMS network effects

data concentration → dark patterns algorithmic opacity → consumer/child/cyber risk.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- DIGITAL HARMS network effects
- data concentration

POWER / PROCEDURE

- dark patterns algorithmic opacity
- consumer/child/cyber risk.

CHECK / LIMIT

- TOOL CHOICE competition law ---+-- data-protection duty consumer law ---+-- sector regulation cyber law ---+-- interoperability/access obligation.
- REFORM TEST clear harm -- statutory power -- impact assessment --> consultation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- conflict control -- proportionate rule -- appeal -- ex post review.
- CURRENT FIREWALL dated Act/rule/order != draft Bill/committee paper/proposal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Digital, data and platform proposals or subordinate frameworks are used only with their dated legal status; no draft is represented as enacted law.

11

STAGE 11 UPSC SYNTHESIS: CALIBRATED INDEPENDENCE UNDER LAW

UPSC SYNTHESIS | CALIBRATED INDEPENDENCE UNDER LAW | PRELIMS FIREWALL STATUTORY | CCI APPEAL=NCLAT REGULATOR INDEPENDENT | BEYOND PARLIAMENT? | MAINS SPINE RATIONALE | THREE AXES | REGULATORY CYCLE

PRELIMS FIREWALL statutory != regulatory != quasi-judicial → dominance != abuse → NCLT != CPCB → TRAI != TDSAT → CCI appeal=NCLAT regulator independent != beyond Parliament

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRELIMS FIREWALL statutory != regulatory != quasi-judicial
- dominance != abuse
- NCLT != CPCB
- TRAI != TDSAT

POWER / PROCEDURE

- CCI appeal=NCLAT regulator independent != beyond Parliament
- proposal != law.
- MAINS SPINE rationale -- three axes -- regulatory cycle -- natural justice
- institutional comparison -- appeal/review -- independence/capture

CHECK / LIMIT

- digital boundary -- reform.
- PYQ SPINE
- FSSAI source
- CCI dominance

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- PNGRB jurisdiction.
- VERDICT expert regulation is legitimate only when mandate, fairness, reasons and review converge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No single appointment formula suits every body, but independence is weak where the regulated ministry controls appointment, tenure, budget, staff and case-specific direction simultaneously.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | SECTORS ARE TECHNICALLY COMPLEX | STANDARDS NEED FREQUENT UPDATING | INDIVIDUAL LICENSING/ENFORCEMENT DECISIONS ARE NUMEROUS | POLITICAL COMMITMENT MUST SURVIVE SHORT CYCLES; AND | EXPERTISE MUST BE CONCENTRATED. | TRANSPARENT CONSULTATION AND RESPONSE-TO-COMMENTS | CONFLICT AND ASSET DISCLOSURE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- sectors are technically complex;
- standards need frequent updating;
- individual licensing/enforcement decisions are numerous;
- political commitment must survive short cycles; and

ADVANCED LINUT

- expertise must be concentrated.
- transparent consultation and response-to-comments;
- conflict and asset disclosure;
- published dissents/reasons where law permits;

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- appeal and parliamentary scrutiny; and
- continuity through staggered terms; and
- chair domination despite formal collegiality.
- separate investigation and adjudication wings;

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels